

NORTH FRISIAN SURVEY - COMMUNITY CONSULTATION SUMMARY

Phase 3 Season (2025) - Three Meetings, Aurich

PI: Prof. Dr. Gloria Gross | Community Liaison: Ailo Reimer

Prepared: 05.10.2025 | Agreed: 08.10.2025

1. Purpose of This Document

This document summarises the three community consultation meetings held in Aurich during the Phase 3 field season. It was prepared jointly by the Principal Investigator and the community liaison representative, Ailo Reimer, and has been reviewed and agreed by both parties. It is provided to the project record and to the DFG as part of the Phase 3 reporting package.

2. Meeting 1 - 19 June 2025

Attendance: 11 community members, PI, community liaison.

The meeting opened with a presentation by the PI on the scope of the 2025 fieldwork and the boundaries of the excavation area at NF-7. Community members asked detailed questions about the chain of custody for recovered material, the process for reporting unexpected finds, and the timeline for any public display of finds. The PI confirmed that all finds remain under heritage authority jurisdiction and that Hamburg Maritime Museum will consult the community before any public display is arranged.

Two oral history accounts were provided by community members relating to historical navigation routes in the North Frisian waters. One account referenced a place name for a shallow area north of Pellworm that does not appear in historical charts and may correspond to the area of the NF-7 site. This information has been logged by the PI and will be incorporated into the Phase 4 research design.

3. Meeting 2 - 28 July 2025

Attendance: 9 community members, PI, community liaison.

The PI presented a mid-season update on finds recovered to date. Photographic records of the ceramic assemblage were shared with community members, with all spatial data removed. Community members identified one ceramic type as potentially connected to a trade route documented in Frisian oral tradition, which the PI will investigate through the comparative literature. Community members expressed satisfaction with the level of information shared.

One community member raised a concern about a commercial fishing vessel that had been seen operating very close to the project area. The PI confirmed that buoy markers are in place at the site boundaries and undertook to report any further encroachment to the relevant maritime authority.

4. Meeting 3 - 04 September 2025

Attendance: 14 community members, PI, community liaison.

The season-close meeting was the best attended. The PI presented a summary of the full Phase 3 results, including the identification of Target T08, described as a possible additional feature of interest to be investigated in a future season. The PI emphasised that no investigation of T08 would be planned without a further community consultation in advance.

Community members discussed their interest in being involved in the publication of results, specifically in contributing a section on place names and oral tradition. The PI welcomed this and confirmed that Chapter 5 of the forthcoming monograph is already planned to include this contribution, and that Ailo Reimer will be credited as a contributing author.

5. Agreed Points

Item	Agreed action	Responsible
Place name documentation	PI to cross-reference community accounts with historical charts	PI before Phase 4 planning
Finds access	Community members to be offered an access visit to HMM conservation lab once treatment is stable	PI
Phase 4 consultation	Minimum two pre-season community meetings before Phase 4 fieldwork commences	PI
Monograph contribution	A. Reimer to be listed as contributing author for Chapter 5	PI
Fishing encroachment	PI to submit formal report to maritime authority if recurrence observed	PI
Exhibition involvement	Community to be consulted on exhibition text and community panel before design is finalised	PI

Signed: Prof. Dr. Gloria Gross, Principal Investigator, 08.10.2025

Signed: Ailo Reimer, Frisian Cultural Heritage Liaison, 08.10.2025